

HTKUNAL PATIL



Network of Terror

MUMBAI The second threat e-mail by the Indian Mujahideen (IM) has found Khalsa College students in the midst of terror investigations. Three students, who were present in the computer laboratory on the August 23 evening, are being questioned by the Mumbai Police and the ATS. The eight-page mail sent to a news channel

that evening has been traced to the college's IP address. Says Principal Ajit Singh, "No one has been arrested or detained. The police have taken the wireless router for investigations but are yet to determine from which computer was the mail sent."

Bearing the IM's logo, the e-mail threatened offi-

TRACKING A TRAIL: ATS officers at Khalsa college

cers of the ATS and the Gujarat police, and said that the recent blasts in Ahmedabad were minor compared to the ones the group was planning.

Interestingly, Khalsa College has a history of terror links. In 2004, Ishrat Jehan, a second-year student at the college, was shot dead by the Gujarat Police for her alleged links with the LeT. The police are now investigating why a computer from the same college was used to send this threat mail. Even as cyber experts are trying to find out whether the college's WiFi Internet system was hacked into, city colleges have started taking steps to rework their Internet networks to prevent the misuse of WiFi technology.

by Aditi Pal

Reservation Riddle

BANGALORE A letter written by the State Commission for Backward Classes to corporates and MNCs asking for a caste and religion-based break-up of their employees has stirred a government-versus-private sector battle yet again. With many Kannada groups demanding reservation for Kannadigas in the private sector, it seems that the storm is still far from subsiding.

Three years ago, when political leaders across the spectrum had called for a similar reservation in the IT sector, the industry had ruled out such a possibility but had given the assurance that local talent would be given the opportunity. At that time, Infosys chairman N.R. Narayana Murthy had stated that most foreign clients do not understand the Indian work scenario. The JD(s) election manifesto had promised 30 per cent reservation for Kannadigas in the state's IT sector, an offer that remained only on paper.

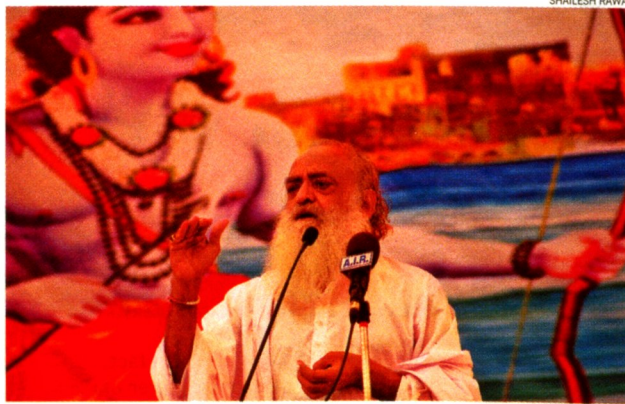
Now again, the new Government led by B.S. Yeddyurappa is being pressurised by Kannada groups and leaders like former home minister M.P. Prakash to implement the 1986 Sarojini Mahishi Committee report, which calls for providing employment to the locals in private sector in one of its recommendations. And with only 11 MNCs out of more than 170 organisations replying to the Commission's letter, the BJP-led regime must brace itself for tough days ahead.

by Stephen David

Problems Aplenty

AHMEDABAD It is not easy being Asaram Bapu, at least not after facing a series of charges including land-grabbing and taking religious followers for a ride. He has become the target of yet another attack, this time by a tantrik Oghad Sukharam. The tantrik has accused him of asking him to use black magic to kill two local media barons and four of his former colleagues, who Bapu believes are responsible for the vilification campaign against him.

Sukharam produced two recorded conversations in which the godman



BREWING TROUBLE: Bapu

talks of the ritual to be conducted. According to him, Shreyans Shah of *Gujarat Samachar* and Parth Falgun Patel of *Sandesh* were on Bapu's hit list. The two papers had been at the forefront of the campaign against Bapu.

Apart from Bapu's conversations, Sukharam also

produced tapes of his conversations with some of Bapu's right-hand men, who talked of paying him Rs 1 lakh as fee. These phone numbers can be traced to Bapu's followers in Delhi. His camp has, however, rubbished these claims calling it yet another falsehood to "demolish his image of a spiritual giant".

by Uday Mahurkar